

Chord Cheatsheet

Roman numerals in 30 seconds

Chords get numbers based on their position in the key. The numbers let you move any pattern into any key.

- **UPPERCASE** = major chord (bright)
- **lowercase** = minor chord (darker)

Number	I	ii	iii	IV	V	vi
Key of C (home key)	C	Dm	Em	F	G	Am
Key of G (optional)	G	Am	Bm	C	D	Em

The **I** chord is **home**. Songs feel finished when they land there.

(There is also a vii° chord — Bdim in C — but pop songs rarely use it. Skip it.)

Ukulele shapes

Four numbers = the four strings, top to bottom: **G C E A**. 0 = open string.

Key of C

- C = 0003
- Dm = 2210
- Em = 0432
- F = 2010
- G = 0232
- Am = 2000

Key of G

- G = 0232
- Am = 2000
- Bm = 4222 (harder)

- C = 0003
- D = 2220
- Em = 0432

Strum patterns, melody notes, and Phase 2 chords are in [Ukulele Songwriter's Guide](#).

What's in each chord (letter names)

You need these for the chord chart beside おんぷノート, and for playing chords on a GarageBand keyboard. A chord is three notes: skip a letter, take one, skip, take one.

Key of C

- C = C E G
- Dm = D F A
- Em = E G B
- F = F A C
- G = G B D
- Am = A C E

Key of G

- G = G B D
- Am = A C E
- Bm = B D F#
- C = C E G
- D = D F# A
- Em = E G B

On a GarageBand keyboard: right hand plays the three notes, left hand plays just the chord's letter name, low.

Famous four-chord loops

Try each one. Write a mood word next to it.

1. **I - V - vi - IV** — C G Am F / G D Em C — Mood: _____
2. **vi - IV - I - V** — Am F C G / Em C G D — Mood: _____
3. **I - vi - IV - V** — C Am F G / G Em C D — Mood: _____
4. **IV - I - V - vi** — F C G Am / C G D Em — Mood: _____
5. **I - IV - vi - V** — C F Am G / G C Em D — Mood: _____

Make your own: pick any four chords from I, ii, iii, IV, V, vi. Rules of thumb:

- Starting on **I** feels settled and bright.
- Starting on **vi** feels emotional.
- Ending on **V** makes you want to go back to the start. Great for loops.

My Song 1 progression: _____ - _____ - _____ - _____ **Tempo:** _____ BPM

Phase 2 chords

See [Minor & Borrowed Chords](#) for minor keys and borrowed chords (Fm, B^b, A^b in C).